

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 2
♥ A Q 8 4 3
♦ 10 8 7 2
♣ 9 4

♠ A 6 4

♥ 7 5 2

♦ A K Q

♣ K J 10 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 8 5 3

♥ K 6

♦ J 6 5 3

♣ A 7 2

♠ Q J 10 7

♥ J 10 9

♦ 9 4

♣ Q 8 6 5

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by North your best bet. You can finesse either defender for the ♣Q so naturally you will finesse East. You dare not let East get into the lead since he can lead through dummy's ♥K. If West gets the lead with the ♣Q, he cannot hurt you.

Win the first trick with the ♠A. (**DO NOT HOLD UP, EAST MAY SWITCH**). Play the ♣K then ♣J, letting it ride if not covered. West can win the ♣Q but cannot lead a ♥ without giving you a trick. You win whatever else he returns and make your 9 tricks. Of course you must be careful to unblock the ♦ A K Q while you still have a dummy entry to the ♦J.

This is another hand where you want to keep a particular defender off lead. In this hand it is East who is the Danger hand.

Be on the lookout for this type of situation because many times you have a finesse that can be made either way. So you finesse into the Safe hand.

Balanced, 17 points. You open 1NT. Partner's response is 2♣.

Partner's 2♣ is Stayman. You have no 4-card Major to show so you bid 2♦. Partner now says 3NT and you pass.

North plays 3NT. East leads ♠Q.

North plays 3NT. East leads ♠Q.

Winners: ♠ 2 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 4 : ♣ 2 : Total = 8

The only thing better than being good is being lucky! You are very lucky that you didn't get a ♥ lead - now you must take advantage of your good luck.

You only need one more winner, and the ♣ suit is your best bet. You can finesse either defender for the ♣Q so naturally you will finesse East. You dare not let East get into the lead since he can lead through dummy's ♥K. If West gets the lead with the ♣Q, he cannot hurt you.

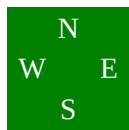
Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q J 10 7 4 3		♠ -
♥ 5		♥ K 6 3
♦ Q 3		♦ K J 10 9 4 2
♣ Q 7 5		♣ 10 9 6 2

♠ A 9 6 2		♠ 8 5
♥ A 8		♥ Q J 10 9 7 4 2
♦ A 8 7 6		♦ 5
♣ A 4 3		♣ K J 8



West	North	East	South
3♠	4♥		3♥
All Pass			

4♥ by South

West probably has a 7-card suit to overcall at the 3-level, so if you play the ♠A East will ruff and one of your winners will disappear. So don't play the ♠A. Duck and let West win the trick while East shows out as expected. West will lead the ♠Q and you duck again. So West will lead the ♠J and you duck one more time, but now you can ruff in your hand.

Lead your ♥Q and finesse, East winning the ♥K. East will probably return a ♦ which you win in dummy. Play the ♥A. Then ruff a ♦ to get back to your hand and pull any trumps left out. Play a ♣ to dummy's ♣A and at long last play dummy's ♠A and discard your ♣ loser.

You always had 10 winners in this hand, as long as one of them didn't disappear.

To make sure the ♠A didn't disappear you had to hold it until East no longer had a trump.

You estimate your hand has 6 playing tricks. That is reasonable for a preemptive 3♥ bid. West overcalls 3♠ and partner bids 4♥. Everybody passes.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♠K.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♠K.

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 1 : Total = 3

This looks way too easy. If the ♥ finesse works and the ♣ finesse works you could make 6. It is when things look too easy that you should look for danger! What if you play the ♠A and East ruffs. What if East also gets a trick with the ♥K and West gets a trick with the ♣Q. What with your ♠ loser you would be down 1.

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 6 5 2
♥ Q 10 7 3
♦ 7
♣ A 8 5 3 2

♠ K 8 7 3
♥ J 8 4 2
♦ 9 6 3
♣ K Q

N
W E
 S

♠ J 10 9 4
♥ 9 6 5
♦ J 8 5 4
♣ 9 4

♠ A Q
♥ A K
♦ A K Q 10 2
♣ J 10 7 6

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♦	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
6NT by North			